

Blockbuster Short — “You’re the company” format

Format: “You’re the company” roleplay. Put the viewer in charge, give them a problem, let the story build, and reveal the company name at the end. **Length:** ~40–45 seconds (~115 words) · **Vertical 9:16** · Voice: Benji (same as the Costco video) **Hook template used:** “Pause for a second...” (from channel/H00K-TEMPLATES.md) **Rule:** don’t say “Blockbuster” or “Netflix” until the last 8 seconds. Viewers stay to find out who it is.

Script

Time	Narration	On-screen text
0:00	Pause for a second. You run the biggest video rental company on Earth.	YOU'RE THE CEO
0:04	Thousands of stores. Packed every Friday night.	THOUSANDS OF STORES
0:07	Late fees alone make you hundreds of millions a year.	LATE FEES 💰
0:11	Then two guys from a tiny startup fly in to meet you.	
0:14	Their company mails DVDs. It's losing money.	LOSING MONEY
0:17	And they want you to buy it... for fifty million dollars.	\$50,000,000
0:21	Would you?	WOULD YOU? 🤔
0:23	You try not to laugh. You say no. They fly home.	NO DEAL
0:27	Then they get faster. Then they start streaming.	
0:31	And ten years later... you're bankrupt.	BANKRUPT
0:34	That tiny startup was Netflix. It's now worth hundreds of billions.	NETFLIX
0:39	And you? You were Blockbuster.	BLOCKBUSTER
0:42	(silent end beat)	WOULD YOU HAVE BOUGHT IT? 🗨️

Plain narration (for the voiceover):

Pause for a second. You run the biggest video rental company on Earth. Thousands of stores. Packed every Friday night. Late fees alone make you hundreds of millions a year. Then two guys from a tiny startup fly in to meet you. Their company mails DVDs. It's losing money. And they want you to buy it... for fifty million dollars. Would you? You try not to laugh. You say no. They fly home. Then they get faster. Then they start streaming. And ten years later... you're bankrupt. That tiny startup was Netflix. It's now worth hundreds of billions. And you? You were Blockbuster.

Why it's built this way

- **Hook (0:00–0:04):** puts the viewer in the CEO's seat right away, so they have something at stake. No statistic-only opening.
- **"Would you?" (0:21):** makes the viewer decide. Most people think "no," so the ending hits them personally.
- **Payoff (0:34–0:42):** the name reveal is the reward for watching to the end.
- **End question:** gets comments ("I would've bought it!"), which helps the Short get shown to more people.

Fact check (verified before posting)

- 2000: Reed Hastings and Marc Randolph offered Netflix to Blockbuster for **\$50 million**. Randolph has said CEO John Antioco was **"struggling not to laugh."** ✓
- Netflix was losing money at the time (mail-order DVDs). ✓
- Late fees were a huge share of Blockbuster's revenue (reported at hundreds of millions per year). ✓
- Blockbuster filed for bankruptcy in **2010**, ten years later. ✓
- Netflix is worth **hundreds of billions** today. ✓

Title & caption

- **YouTube Short title:** You had the chance to buy Netflix for \$50 million... #business #netflix #blockbuster
- **TikTok / Instagram / Facebook caption:** Would you have bought it? 🤔 #business #netflix #blockbuster #businesstok
- **Related video (YouTube):** set to your best-performing Short (per the posting settings).

Shot list — Blockbuster Short (vertical 9:16)

17 shots, a new picture about every 2.5 seconds. Add zooms, pans and shake in the editor (free).

Type	Count
 New image (9:16)	14
 Reuse an earlier image with a new crop/zoom	3

Style block (put in front of every prompt)

Stickman cartoon explainer illustration, vertical 9:16: bold clean black ink outlines, flat bright cel-shaded colors, simple shapes, warm saturated backgrounds, clean comic look. Match the style of the reference image (stickman-anchor-1). No logos, no brand names, no readable text.

Characters (keep the same in every shot)

- **YOU (the CEO):** stick-figure man, round white head, black dot eyes, thick eyebrows, navy suit, **bright yellow tie**, confident smirk.
- **THE FOUNDERS:** two young stick-figure men in casual clothes (one in a grey hoodie, one with glasses and a plain t-shirt), slightly nervous.
- **Store colors:** blue building with a yellow ticket-shaped sign, **no words or logos**. **Envelopes:** plain red, no text.

All words on screen (YOU'RE THE CEO, \$50,000,000, BANKRUPT, etc.) get added in the editor so they're spelled right.

#	Time	Narration	Image	Type	Prompt
1	0:00–0:02	Pause for a second.	CEO in a big leather chair turns to face the camera, smirking		the CEO sitting in a giant leather office chair spinning to face the viewer, smug smile, tall window with city skyline behind him
2	0:02–0:04	You run the biggest video rental company on Earth.	CEO standing on top of a giant pile of VHS tapes and DVD cases like a king		the CEO standing proudly on top of a huge mountain of video tapes and movie cases, arms raised, wearing a small gold crown
3	0:04–0:07	Thousands of stores. Packed every Friday night.	Map covered in blue store pins / row of blue stores with lines out the door		a long street of identical blue video rental stores with yellow ticket-shaped signs, long lines of stick-figure customers out every door, evening sky

#	Time	Narration	Image	Type	Prompt
4	0:07–0:11	Late fees alone make you hundreds of millions a year.	CEO swimming in money as tapes get returned through a drop slot		the CEO laughing while a river of cash pours out of a video return drop box onto him, stacks of money everywhere
5	0:11–0:14	Then two guys from a tiny startup fly in to meet you.	The two founders in a giant glass lobby looking tiny		two small nervous stick-figure founders standing in a huge shiny corporate lobby, looking up at tall glass walls, one holding a red envelope
6	0:14–0:15.5	Their company mails DVDs.	Founder holding up a red envelope with a DVD sliding out		close-up of a founder holding a plain red envelope with a shiny DVD disc sliding out of it, hopeful face
7	0:15.5–0:17	It's losing money.	Chart arrow crashing down behind the founders		the two founders in front of a big chart whose red arrow is falling down, sweating, awkward smiles
8	0:17–0:21	And they want you to buy it... for fifty million dollars.	Founders slide a paper across a long boardroom table to the CEO		long boardroom table, the two founders sliding a single sheet of paper across to the CEO at the far end, dramatic overhead lights
9	0:21–0:23	Would you?	Close-up on the CEO's face, one eyebrow raised (slow zoom in)	 crop of #8	—
10	0:23–0:25	You try not to laugh.	CEO with cheeks puffed, holding in laughter, hand over mouth		close-up of the CEO pressing a hand over his mouth, cheeks puffed, eyes watering from holding in laughter
11	0:25–0:27	You say no. They fly home.	Founders walking away into the rain, red envelope drooping		the two founders walking away down a rainy street at night, shoulders slumped, one holding a drooping red envelope
12	0:27–0:29	Then they get faster.	Red envelopes flying out of a mailbox like a storm		hundreds of plain red envelopes flying out of a mailbox like a swarm of birds over a neighborhood

#	Time	Narration	Image	Type	Prompt
13	0:29–0:31	Then they start streaming.	Family on a couch watching a glowing TV, empty blue store in the window		stick-figure family relaxing on a couch watching a glowing TV, through the window behind them an empty blue video store with no customers
14	0:31–0:34	And ten years later... you're bankrupt.	CEO sitting alone in an empty store, "CLOSING" sign, tumbleweed (add shake)		the CEO sitting alone on a box in an empty video store with bare shelves, dust, a tumbleweed rolling past, sad face
15	0:34–0:39	That tiny startup was Netflix. It's now worth hundreds of billions.	The two founders, now older, on top of a mountain of money		the two founders, now older and confident, standing on top of an enormous mountain of gold coins, red confetti falling
16	0:39–0:42	And you? You were Blockbuster.	Slow push-in on the CEO in the empty store	 zoom of #14	—
17	0:42–0:44	(end beat) WOULD YOU HAVE BOUGHT IT?	Back to the boardroom paper, frozen, question text on top	 crop of #8	—

Optional animated hook

Animate **shot 1** (CEO spinning around in the chair) as a short AI video clip for more movement in the first seconds. Only do this as the A/B test, and quote the credits before generating.